software, generating code, and providing production support. Legacy modernisation illustrates the scale of the change. Work that once required teams to manually comb through millions of lines of old computer code can be accelerated by AI agents that inspect the software, extract embedded rules and map the way the application works.

Not just an assistant, there is another half that AI agents are looking at. That half is also the 'repetitive' part of the workload. For example, Dhok of Persistent Systems points out that in a financial-services operation, Persistent has used agents to help categorise work arriving through emails and tickets and decide how it should be routed, reducing problems related to adherence to service-level agreements by about 80%.

In healthcare, the IT services provider has worked with an American kidney-care organisation where clinical, claims and patient information must be pulled together to help manage chronic patients and reduce hospital readmissions. The attraction of an agent is not simply that it can perform faster but that it can potentially connect several parts of a process such as pulling out clinical data, insurance claims data and patient data from three different silos. Earlier, this required people to move information between systems. Now, AI agents do the job.

AI agents have also transformed customer-support operations. A traditional call centre is labour intensive. Someone answers the phone, checks quality, categorises calls, and writes notes after a conversation. There is also a supervisor to monitor the agents. Teams make outbound reminder calls and route problems elsewhere. AI can now insert itself at several points simultaneously.

Udit Agarwal, Vice President and Head of Global Marketing, Exotel, which builds and runs AI agents used by contact centres and enterprises, sees three emerging roles for AI agents. One is the autonomous front-line resolver, which is capable of handling routine requests such as order status, balance checks, delivery tracking, know-your-customer procedures, and appointment bookings. Second sits next to the human executive as a real-time copilot, producing transcripts, suggesting answers and summarising the call. Third is as a quality analyst, reviewing conversations and scoring performance.

"A human quality team may listen and review only 2-5% calls. An AI system can evaluate all of them. After-call work is another target. Notes and disposition tagging that once consumed a few minutes after every conversation can be produced while the call is under way," says Agarwal.

Similarly, outbound reminder calls (say for a bill due), basic routing and recitation of tracking numbers or bank account information can now be delegated to machines.

AI agents are taking the tasks that make up jobs. A human analyst may remain an analyst but no longer spend the morning gathering data. A software developer may remain a developer but write less boilerplate code. A customer-service employee may receive fewer ordinary calls but a higher propor-

AI PUSH BY TOP-TIER INDIAN FIRMS

	TCS	HCLTech	Wipro	Infosys
AI REVENUE (FY26)	$2.3 BILLION	$620 MILLION	NA	NA
% OF FY26 REVENUE SPENT IN AI	7-8%	4-5%	NA	NA
AI PLATFORM/OFFERING	AI.Cloud for AI services; GenAI platforms; Industry AI (BFSI, retail, manufacturing); 180k+ AI skilled workforce	AI Force2.0; engineering-led AI; Embedded AI in ER&D	Wipro HOLMES; Lab45 GenAI; 225k+ GenAI trained workforce	Infosys Topaz; 275k+ AI trained workforce

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